

Part 1

Read Passage One and answer questions 1-7 in the Question-Answer Book.

Passage One:

If a friendship drifts apart, how can you reconnect?

- 1 [1] Whether you have not seen a friend in a while or lost touch during the Covid-19 pandemic, reconnecting after an extended period of absence can be awkward. Psychologist Irene S. Levine, who is also an advice columnist known as "The Friendship Doctor", shared her advice for rekindling friendships. It all starts with whether both people are still motivated to keep in touch.
- 5 [2] "Friendships are essentially voluntary relationships, and they need to be satisfying to both individuals in order to work. While some friendships end because of misunderstandings or dramatic betrayals, the large majority of friendship break-ups occur because people simply drift apart," said the author of The Friendship Blog website and *Best Friends Forever: Surviving a Breakup with Your Best Friend*.
- 10 [3] She explained a few reasons teen friendships drift apart. This is a stage in life when you are defining your sense of self. Some people might be more focused on academics, hobbies or even romance. It is also common to lose touch with secondary school friends after graduation.
- 15 [4] The longer it has been since a friendship ended, the tougher it will be to return to how things were. "The passage of time can throw a crimp in any relationship. In such cases, an individual may wonder if they did or said something wrong to ruin the friendship, and whether the lack of contact was intentional," she said. This can create a vicious cycle in which someone feels unsure about whether to reach out, while also prolonging the time since they last spoke to their friend.
- 20 [5] Levine suggested starting with small steps such as sending a message to check in. Social media is great for keeping up with old friends, as you can easily comment on posts or reply to stories. This can naturally lead to a conversation and give you a sense of how they are doing. "If they are starting a new part-time job to pay off their tuition fees or are involved in a new romance, they may have less time for friends right now and may seem unwilling to hang out," she said. "Don't take it personally. It may have nothing to do with you but more likely that they are too busy with other things happening in their life."
- 25 [6] If the other person is responding to your efforts and seems interested in chatting more, try to find out how comfortable they are with meeting up, and make plans to catch up in person or over a call. Chances are that they are glad you made the first move and might have been meaning to reach out too.
- 30 [7] It can be tricky to catch up when you have not spoken to someone for a long time. Your friend's life may have changed dramatically, especially amid the pandemic, and you might worry about delving into sensitive topics. Levine pointed out: "The pandemic's impact on friendships ... is dependent on factors such as the nature of one's pre-pandemic friendships, their personality and communication styles, their social and emotional needs, and even their post-pandemic life situation."
- 35 [8] Give the other person space to share only what they are comfortable with. If you are nervous about what to discuss, you can bond over shared memories and create new ones. In cases where you had a falling out with this person, resolve the conflict before making attempts to reconnect. Rather than reaching out and pretending the argument did not happen, state your intentions behind contacting them. Let them know that you miss them and want to make an apology before asking if they are keen to hang out again.
- [9] However, Levine warned that there might also be friendships that have outlived their course, and it would be a good idea to let some time pass before reconnecting. "It is important to realise the friendship was not a failure and see this as an opportunity to move on from something both of you have outgrown," she said.

Read Passage Two and answer questions 8-14 in the Question-Answer Book.

Passage Two:

Hong Kong star refuses to dim

- 1 [1] Casually swinging his long umbrella, Wong Kam-fai was carefree as he reported for his first day of work at the Star Ferry in 2004. "My boss still remembers me doing that," he chuckled, thinking back to the time when he was leaving his hectic job as a buyer of silk fabrics.
- 5 [2] Eighteen years ago, Wong took a chance on a job posting in the newspaper from the Star Ferry Company. "I wanted to take a break," the 61-year-old said, adding that his previous job required him to travel a lot. It took him some time to adjust, but he has now mastered the physically demanding skills of operating one of Hong Kong's most iconic vessels.
- 10 [3] After nearly two decades with the Star Ferry, Wong felt the job had changed him for the better. "I used to be a workaholic, working from morning to night. I would seldom see my son or eat with my wife. It's so much better now," he shared, adding that he could now eat dinner with his family for half of the days in a month.
- 15 [4] Each morning, Wong cleans the boat and checks if the cables attaching the boat to the shore have frayed. Throughout his shift, which can last eight to nine hours, the sailor operates the gangway – the path that passengers take to board the ship – and he helps moor the vessel to keep it in place until everyone is on the boat. "Every day, you lasso the mooring line dozens of times. The cable weighs about 30 pounds, and when it's raining, it can be even heavier," he explained. While the tasks may seem repetitive, Wong has never felt that his work is dull: "I wouldn't have been here for more than a decade if I thought the job was boring."
- 20 [5] There have even been times when he has rescued people from the waters. "I've saved four people from jumping into the sea during my 18 years," he said. Even after all this time, the veteran crew member noted that the view continued to be as mesmerising as it was on his first day – land reclamation might shorten the commute, but it could not dampen his admiration.
- 25 [6] Still, he admitted fewer people nowadays shared his fondness for the 124-year-old company: "Comparing the heyday of Star Ferry to now, I feel some mixed emotions." Back in the day, many chose to cross the harbour on the Star Ferry so they could enjoy the sea breeze. "A lot of the customers I know who live in Whampoa would come to ride the ferry from Tsim Sha Tsui instead of taking the cross-harbour bus right there," Wong said. He recalled the ferries being so packed that commuters crammed themselves near the room with the boat's steering wheel, which was supposed to be off-limits. At its peak, the ferry had over 100,000 monthly riders, but in recent years, it gets only 10,000 or 20,000, he said.
- 30 [7] With the pandemic, (i). "Now ... the ferry is not full even during the morning and evening rush hour," he said. "There are so few people that we only need two vessels each day." The company revealed in March a sharp decline in passengers and revenue since 2019, sparking concern that the ferry service was on the brink of ceasing operations. But the company said it had no plans to close down. Wong is also confident the ferry will find a way to survive.
- 35 [8] "Hong Kong people ... will help each other," he said, (ii). The spirit of his colleagues amid trying times also inspires Wong to stay positive about the ferry's future. "All our colleagues are so cooperative and united. No one took unnecessary leave ... during the pandemic. During the political turmoil, (iii)," he shared. "This kind of dedication already says it all. So I don't think Star Ferry will have any trouble."
- 40 [9] Even for Wong, who is at the age of retirement, he still enjoys his work too much to leave. "If the company needs you and if you like the company too, then why not continue working here?" If the Star Ferry were to disappear from Victoria Harbour, he said it would be like something was missing at home. "[For example] I have had a pet turtle at home for 20 years. If suddenly it's not there, (iv)." "When I was in primary school, I always ... went to the ferry pier and crossed the harbour to meet my dad, so it's a personal attachment," he said, adding that his dad sailed yachts in Causeway Bay for a living. "If the Star Ferry is gone, perhaps this route will be gone – that would be a shame."

END OF READING PASSAGES



FORM 3

GENERAL ENGLISH

QUESTION-ANSWER BOOK

Name: _____

Class: _____

Class Number: _____

Set 3

Part 1 – Reading Comprehension (30 marks)

For each multiple-choice question, darken the appropriate circle. Otherwise, no mark will be awarded.

Passage One (16 marks)

1. What does Levine work as? (2 marks)

2. According to Levine, why do most friendships end?

- A. People experience betrayal.
- B. People grow apart over time.
- C. They get weary of each other's company.
- D. Friends argue with each other.

A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

3. Use the information in the article to decide whether the following statements are True, False or Not Given. (5 marks)

- | | T | F | NG |
|--|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| (i) The author of the Friendship Blog shares what to do if you want to reconnect with someone that you haven't seen or spoken to in a while. | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| (ii) Friendships can be rekindled as long as one party puts in the effort. | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| (iii) It is more difficult to reconnect if the friendship has ended more recently. | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| (iv) Social media sites such as Instagram can be a good way to determine whether someone might be open to reconnecting. | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| (v) There is a lower chance of saving a friendship after the Covid-19 pandemic. | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

T F NG

4. According to Levine, why might some people be hesitant to reconnect with friends after a long period of time?

5. Name two actions Levine recommends for getting back in touch with a friend using social media. (2 marks)

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

6. Based on the information in the article, what is one safe topic to discuss if someone is unsure of what to say when meeting an old friend?

- A. Shared experiences that both people have had in the past together
- B. Social issues such as the pandemic
- C. The arguments that led to the friendship break-up
- D. Academics, hobbies, or even romance

A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

7. Using information from the article, complete the passage on rekindling a friendship. Make sure your answers are grammatically correct. (4 marks)

Steps to rekindle a friendship

If you had an argument with a friend, you can explain why you want to get back together and offer an (i) _____ if necessary. You can schedule a (ii) _____ or in-person meeting if they accept your apologies and are eager to re-establish contact. If they choose to ignore you, on the other hand, you are free to walk away and return when they are ready.

If your friendship starts to sour, you might casually check in with your friends on (iii) _____ to see how they are doing. You can arrange to meet up if they appear (iv) _____ in talking. However, if they don't appear eager to chat, you can leave them alone and follow up with them when they're ready.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Passage Two (14 marks)

8. Look at the word 'dim' in the title. Now look at the dictionary entry for 'dim' below. Which meaning corresponds to its meaning in the text?

dim /dɪm/

- A. (adjective) not giving or having much light
- B. (adjective) not very clever
- C. (verb) to make something become less bright
- D. (verb) to become less strong

A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

9. Which phrase in paragraphs 1 to 3 means requiring a lot of energy and body strength?

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

10. According to the article, which of the following are Wong's duties as a sailor?

- (i) operating the path that passengers take to board the ferry
- (ii) saving people from the sea
- (iii) cleaning the vessel
- (iv) steering the ship
- (v) lassoing the mooring line

- A. (i) and (iii)
- B. (i), (iii) and (v)
- C. (ii), (iv) and (v)
- D. All of the above

A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

11. Find two words from paragraph 6 to replace the word "passengers".

(2 marks)

_____ and _____

12. Phrases are missing from paragraphs 7 to 9. From the five phrases A to E below, choose four which best complete the blanks in the text. Write the letters in the spaces provided. Use each letter ONCE only. ONE phrase is not used.

(4 marks)

- A. adding that more people rode the route after rumours circulated that it would close down
- B. the interval frequency of the ferries was around 10 -12 minutes
- C. no one was absent without reason
- D. passengers dwindled even more
- E. I would not be used to it

i	ii	iii	iv

13. Using information from the article, complete the summary. Make sure your answers are grammatically correct.

(3 marks)

Despite the (i) _____ decrease in the company's revenue since 2019, Wong Kam-fai, a Star Ferry (ii) _____ member who has worked there for (iii) _____ years, still holds a deep appreciation for the 124-year-old company.

14. Does Wong think that the future of Star Ferry is hopeless? Support your answer with one reason.

(2 marks)

END OF PART 1

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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Part 2 – English Usage (70 marks)

A. Verb Forms (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the words provided in brackets in their correct forms.

Art tech in Hong Kong

Art tech refers to (1) (use) technology, such as virtual reality and animation, to enhance the delivery of artistic creations.

In 2020, the Hong Kong government (2) (announce) plans to “actively promote and support the development of art tech”, (3) (set) aside a total of HK \$100 million to boost Hong Kong’s creative capital.

A test bed studio, which (4) (serve) as a breeding ground for experimental uses of art tech, is slated to open next year at the East Kowloon Cultural Centre.

“Art tech should be included in children’s learning routines because this generation (5) (not build) their success solely on conventional learning paths like the piano, chess, books or painting anymore,” said Ching Lee, an arts curator and founder of NFT Kids Hong Kong.

What’s on the digital playground for kids?

Zigazoo, a TikTok-like app that (6) (pride) itself on being the “world’s largest social network and NFT education platform for kids”, is aimed at children as young as three.

The app allows users (7) (create) an avatar, produce digital content as NFTs, and buy and sell content using the platform’s in-app virtual currency. In terms of education, children can use a short video format to answer questions like “Can you use your five senses to describe an item at home?”, and they can share their responses with friends on the app.

The founder of Zigazoo, Zak Ringelstein, (8) (inspire) to create the app after noticing his children’s excessive screen time during the Covid-19 pandemic. As a way to embrace the fact that there was no use (9) (try) to tell the younger generation to cut back on their time online, he turned to the idea of combining entertainment and education together.

The app claims to teach kids “essential financial literacy” and that Web3 will become “a huge part of our children’s future”, but critics pointed out that it also leads young kids on the path to TikTok, and that it may be too early for them (10) (expose) to digital gadgets and platforms.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.	6.	7.	8.
9.	10.		

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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B. Vocabulary (5 marks)

Choose the most suitable words from the table below to complete the sentences. You may need to change the form of the words. Each word should only be used **once**.

specific	dubbed	widespread	contamination	adept
futile	conform	entangle	capacity	sufficiently

The government always urges us to conserve water, even though we do not seem to be running out. We have many reservoirs and the summer months bring torrential rain, but this leads to a (1) misconception. Behind the scenes, ensuring adequate water supply for the territory has never been easy.

Water from Dongjiang, Guangdong is in fact the biggest water source for Hong Kong. We started getting our water from Dongjiang in 1965.

Since the late 1990s, 70-80 percent of our annual demand has been supplied by Dongjiang water. In 2013-14, 598 million cubic metres of Dongjiang water was imported, slightly more than the total storage (2) of our reservoirs. But we can import more if needed – up to 1.1 billion cubic metres per annum.

Dongjiang water and water from reservoirs does not go straight to our taps. It has to go through a treatment process. The Water Supplies Department ensures that the water we drink is among the safest in the world, and its quality fully (3) to World Health Organisation standards.

Experts monitor the water throughout the system, and over 100,000 samples are taken for testing every year. There were, however, concerns that Dongjiang water might be (4) by pollution from Guangdong.

Our supply agreement with Guangdong (5) that the water must reach a certain standard, and the mainland authorities have taken measures to meet them. These include preventing wastewater from entering the water source, constructing sewage treatment plants, and controlling land-use planning and polluting activities.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.			

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

C. Parts of Speech (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the appropriate forms of the words in brackets.

In a world where making money in tech is often lauded as a lucrative job, many parents are in a hurry to educate their children on everything about cryptocurrency, from non-fungible tokens (NFTs) to Web3, with the goal of preparing them to live and work in an (1) (immerse) digital environment.

But one Hong Kong arts curator, who has launched an educational project about art tech for the city's students, wants people to know exactly what they're getting into – and that it isn't all about money.

Before betting on the digital (2) (crazy) and encouraging children to invest time and money in Roblox or other digital playgrounds, here's what the younger generation needs to know about NFTs.

NFTs = money?

"Many secondary school students are aware of NFTs but think of them as a way to make a (3) (fortunately)," said Ching Lee, an arts curator and founder of NFT Kids Hong Kong, which educates young people on how to do art through NFTs using workshops and seminars.

"If everyone learns about NFTs through the lens of investment, I feel like it will go in the wrong direction, because you shouldn't encourage young children to invest," she added.

Though many people have earned money through NFTs, Lee (4) (cautious) that they should not be treated as a (5) (commodify) or be expected to make money in a heartbeat.

"Don't rush into the trend. A lot of people only come across (6) (succeed) cases ... but the hard fact is that oftentimes, nothing happens when you upload an NFT unless you are a public figure," she said, adding that if children expect to earn money, they might be disappointed and (7) (loss) their motivation to continue.

How should young children go about NFTs?

Rather than teaching young people that NFTs allow them to trade or invest, Lee wants people to know how it also allows them to create their own "art portfolio" that can be seen by people from around the world.

"The (8) (apply) of NFTs are far-reaching, and we should teach children about them from the direction of art tech," she said.

She explained that students can think of it like giving their teacher a Christmas card in a paperless way. After you finish making the (9) (illustrator), you can send it to your teacher (10) (virtualise) so that he or she can see it on their phone whenever they want and not risk losing it.

"It's like putting a drawing in a place called a blockchain, where everyone can see it, including the date you created it, and you aren't allowed to change anything about it after you upload it," she said.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.	6.	7.	8.
9.	10.		

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

D. Used to / Be used to (5 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the correct forms of “used to” or “be used to”, using the correct form of the words given in the brackets.

When Ricky was a young actor, he was well-liked among the young and had a busy schedule. He (1) (be) surrounded by hundreds of adoring followers wherever he went. To the surprise of most, he (2) (not face) the camera since he found it difficult to express his true feelings in front of the public. During the premiere of his film in 2017, Ricky stated that he (3) (not, sign) so many autographs.

Ricky has become more mature after years of performance. Now, he (4) (express) himself openly during interviews. He can explain why he (5) (feel) shy when he was younger. ‘In the past, most people were more reserved. Now that people are more accepting and open-minded, everything is possible.’

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.			

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

E. Inversion (10 marks)

Complete the sentence so that it means the same as the first sentence.

1. Peter had no sooner got on the train than he realised he had left the office key at home.

No sooner _____

2. The football match had hardly started when it began to rain.

Hardly _____

3. I have seldom watched such an amazing performance.

Seldom _____

4. I have never seen a more obvious case of lying.

Never _____

5. They not only cleaned the house, but they also decorated it with a Christmas tree.

Not only _____

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

F. Multiple-choice Cloze (10 marks)

Read the following text. Decide which of the choices would best complete the text if inserted in the blanks. Write the **letter** of each answer in the space provided.

Reality Unplugged

With the internet still in its (1) back in 1999, PCs all over the world started to get strange emails, posing the question “what is *The Matrix*?” Surfers were directed to equally cryptic websites with green symbols trickling down a black background. Was it a sinister underground plot (2) a big hoax by hackers? It turned out to be a new movie and the advertising potential of the internet had become apparent.

When *The Matrix* hit cinemas in the spring, people were blown away by the slick audio and visual feast before them. It was like a highly detailed Japanese anime cartoon but made with real actors. The most famous special effect pioneered by *The Matrix* was “bullet time” where a blisteringly fast action scene was slowed down and viewed from multiple angles. (3) detail could be seen – even the shock waves created as a bullet cut through the air.

Bullet time was one of the characteristics of *The Matrix* – a computer-generated world designed by evil machines, hellbent on enslaving human beings. (4) virtual reality had been explored previously in earlier films, like *Tron* with its pixelated featureless backgrounds, *The Matrix* made VR (5) contemporary and ordinary. The idea that people living seemingly ordinary lives were actually trapped in a computer programme far in the future was truly mind blowing and was the first time that a major science fiction action film explored concepts like existentialism and spiritualism.

The nod to Japanese cartoons was not the only cultural reference in the film. We also see the central character go through an “Alice in Wonderland” journey, (6) he can choose to take a blue or red pill to determine his path, echoing Alice’s magic potion choice. There were also constant tributes to Hong Kong action films – most notably when two characters have a (7) kung fu fight.

For that feast of martial mayhem, the directors used the skills of (8) Hong Kong fight choreographer Yuen Woo-ping who designed kinetic balletic action never seen in an American film before. The fight scenes were so successful that it started a trend of Hollywood action filmmakers hiring Hong Kong action directors to provide high impact visuals. (9) it is pretty rare not to see at least some martial arts in an action movie these days.

Finally, *The Matrix* paved the way for action films to have a soundtrack that was as (10) as the visuals it accompanied. Rousing songs from the likes of Rage Against the Machine and The Prodigy gelled perfectly with the pyrotechnics on the screen.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

1. A. infancy B. infant C. mature D. maturity	2. A. but B. and C. nor D. or	3. A. All B. Every C. One D. Many
4. A. Despite B. Although C. In spite of D. Unless	5. A. seeming B. to seem C. seem D. to have seemed	6. A. where B. which C. whose D. whom
7. A. voluminous B. boundless C. spacious D. massive	8. A. apprentice B. veteran C. novice D. amateur	9. A. In true B. Indeedly C. In fact D. As matter of fact
10. A. more explosive B. the most explosive C. explosiver D. explosive		

1.	2.	3.	4.	5.
6.	7.	8.	9.	10.

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G. Conditional clauses (10 marks)

Complete the conditional clause with the words given for each question. Add pronouns and prepositions where appropriate.

Alex	Siobhan is amazing! If she hadn't been so hardworking, (1) (not / be successful / now).
Chris	You are right! You can only break a world record if (2) (dedicate yourself / challenges).
Alex	Imagine you were her swimming, (3) (how / feel / at that time)?
Chris	I would be dog-tired for sure! (4) (never train / for / it) unless I was paid 1 million dollars.
Alex	Haha, even if you gave me 1 million dollars, (5) (not survive / the pain)!

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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H. Proofreading (10 marks)

Proofread the following text (numbered lines 1-10 only) without changing the meaning. No lines have more than one mistake and at least one line is correct. Do not make any changes to punctuation and do not make unnecessary changes. Use ONE word only for each correction. If you think there are no mistakes in a line, put a ✓ at the end of the line (example c).

Corrections must be done as follows:

Extra word: delete the extra word with a 'X' (example a).

Missing word: mark the position of the missing word with a '^' and write the missing word above it (example b).

Wrong word: underline the wrong word and write the correct word above it (example d).

a	When I was younger, my friends and I would X try to scare each other
b	by telling ghost stories. I never got frightened because I did not believe ^ ghosts.
c	In fact, I would laugh at anyone who said they did. However, I changed my ✓
d	mind about this last summer when I was staying <u>at</u> my aunt in Guangzhou.

- 1 Colonial architecture has long been being a symbol of Hong Kong's history, but it is
- 2 becoming increasing hard to find. The classic Victorian brick structures rose to
- 3 prominence from the mid-19th century when the city was ruled by the British. The visually
- 4 stunning buildings are treasured by local and tourists alike – perhaps because there are
- 5 so little of them left. In the 1980s and 90s, construction companies began demolishing the
- 6 buildings and replacing them modern skyscrapers. Although this has led to Hong Kong
- 7 become the city with the most skyscrapers in the world, we're still happy to be able
- 8 to see remnants of our colonial pass, such as the Flagstaff House, the Central Police
- 9 Station and the old Supreme Court – they are, after all, part of our history – and hope they
- 10 will remind in the city for years to come.

END OF PAPER

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.